



4-Week Transition Plan: Developer to QA Engineer

Your goal of moving into QA is achievable, especially with your strong development and cloud background. Here's a focused 4-week plan designed for immediate job readiness, featuring two resume-worthy projects and clear daily commitments.

Overall Time Commitment

- **Total daily hours:** 3–4 hours (consistent study and project work)
- **Weeks:** 4 (28 days in total)
- **Total estimate:** ~84–112 hours (enough for a solid transition while working full-time on your job hunt)

Week-by-Week Roadmap

Week 1: Foundations of QA and Manual Testing

Goal: Master core principles and manual QA processes.

- **Daily hours:** 3–4
- **Topics:**
 - Understanding SDLC & STLC
 - QA methodologies (Agile, Waterfall)
 - Types of testing: functional, integration, system, regression, UAT
 - Test case creation, execution, and reporting bugs (use tools like Jira or Trello)
 - Common test documentation: test plans, cases, bug reports
- **Hands-on:**
 - Start *Project 1: Manual Testing a Simple Web App* (E.g., an open-source e-commerce site or your own Flask/Django CRUD app)
 - Write detailed test cases
 - Execute them and document found bugs

Week 2: Test Automation Basics

Goal: Gain automation skills with Selenium and Python (you already know Python!)

- **Daily hours:** 3–4
- **Topics:**

- Overview of test automation, benefits, and frameworks
- Selenium basics: locators, interacting with web elements, assertions
- Writing your first scripts (login, form submission, validations)
- Basic Page Object Model
- **Hands-on:**
 - Convert some of your manual tests from *Project 1* into Selenium automation scripts

Week 3: Automation Frameworks & API Testing

Goal: Build a small automation suite and practice API testing.

- **Daily hours:** 3–4
- **Topics:**
 - Improving Selenium automation: test structure, data-driven tests
 - Introduction to PyTest/UnitTest for test orchestration
 - Using Postman for API testing (test GET/POST, assertions, chaining)
- **Hands-on:**
 - Build a mini-framework around your scripts from Week 2
 - *Project 2:* API Test Suite (Public APIs like reqres.in or openweather)
 - Test different endpoints, assert responses, document coverage

Week 4: CI/CD Integration, Reporting & Resume Prep

Goal: Demonstrate a “DevOps” mindset: integrate test automation into pipelines and create presentable results.

- **Daily hours:** 3–4
- **Topics:**
 - Integrate automation scripts with CI/CD tools (GitHub Actions, Azure Pipelines)
 - Automated test execution and reporting (HTML/JUnit reports)
 - QA best practices: test coverage, flakiness, environment setup
 - Prepare resume, document your projects, portfolio on GitHub
 - Practice answering QA interview questions
- **Hands-on:**
 - Set up and demo your automation suite running in CI/CD
 - Polish documentation for both projects:
 - *Project 1:* “Manual & Automated Testing for [App Name]”
 - *Project 2:* “API Test Suite for [API Name]”

Project Ideas for Your Resume

Here are two solid, market-friendly projects:

Project	Skills Highlighted	Outcome / Deliverables
Manual+Automated Testing of Web App	Manual testing, bug reporting, Selenium, test docs, CI/CD	Test cases, bug reports, Python/Selenium code, Test plan, CI pipeline
API Test Suite (with Postman + Py)	API testing, automation, assertions, reporting, PyTest/Unittest	Postman collections, automated scripts, reports, code on GitHub

Tips for a Strong QA Resume and Job Apps

- Show detailed test case and bug report samples.
- Highlight your ability to create both manual and automated tests.
- Link to GitHub repos for both projects.
- Mention familiarity with CI/CD, test planning, and documentation.
- Leverage your developer experience: QA with a “developer’s mindset” is a strong selling point.

Final Notes

- Maintain a steady pace (could accelerate if you have more time some days).
- Use weekends to review, polish, or catch up if needed.
- Mock interviews in the last week are highly recommended.
- Stay visible on job boards, update your LinkedIn with “Actively looking—QA roles.”

This plan will get you market-ready for junior to mid-level QA positions in a month if you stay disciplined and are hands-on throughout.